

Across Borders: The Disagreement

跨越边界：分歧

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The disagreement was about **ownership**, and it had a **famous** ancestor. “After a year of work, who has the right to the **patent**?” the **chief** of the local committee asked. “The **navy** has a rule for a **wreck**, a **dictator** has a rule for a **ballot**, and a **diplomat** has a rule for a **tyre**. We have none.” A woman in the front row began to **explain** the **distinction**, and the room went quiet.

Generally speaking, the team wanted a **salary**, a **wage**, and a share; **specifically**, they wanted the right to **privatize** nothing and to **inherit** the name. “A **privatization** is not a **pardon**,” Aisha said, “and a **patent** is not a reward.” A **warrior** of the old school, a **well-known** local businessman, and a **selfless** volunteer all nodded, which was **disappointing** to nobody. They could not **obtain** the **forthcoming** decision in writing, and the sum was **allegedly** unpaid, but that was to be expected.

In **accordance** with their **own** rule, they tossed a coin instead of taking a vote. The result was a **historic** one for the area: the right would be held by the people who used the road, not by the company that had built it. “We are not **solely** a service,” Maya said. “We are also a habit, and a habit is harder to **punish** than a crime.”

After a week of talking, the **chief** dictated a short clause and the local people signed it. “**Yourselves**, not the **wireless**, not the **webcast**, and not the **gadgetry**,” she said. “You cannot leave an **old-fashioned** promise to a machine.” A **considerate** neighbour brought **woolen** blankets, and a **fluent** speaker of three languages read the clause aloud to the queue.

They agreed to spend the money **sparingly** and to keep one **exclamation** out of the report: “At last!” It was an **altogether** better ending than a quarrel, and their friend the motel owner said so. A child from the night queue, a local car owner, and a woman who had lived there all her life stood behind them at the counter. The people at home always have the last word, and that was fine.

中文翻译

分歧在于所有权，而它有一个著名的祖先。“工作一年之后，谁有权拿到这项专利？”本地委员会的领袖问。“海军对沉船有规则，独裁者对选票有规则，外交官对轮胎有规则。我们什么都没有。”前排一位女士开始解释这个区别，屋里安静下来。

一般来说，团队想要薪水、工资和一份份额；具体来说，他们想保留不私有化任何东西的权利，并继承这个名字。“私有化不是赦免，”艾莎说，“专利也不是奖赏。”一位老派的战士、一位著名的本地商人，以及一位无私的志愿者都点了头，这一点没有让任何人失望。他们拿不到即将到来的书面决定，款项据称也未支付，但这也在预料之中。

按照他们自己的规则，他们抛硬币而不是投票。对这个地区来说，结果具有历史意义：这项权利将由使用这条道路的人持有，而不是由修建它的公司持有。“我们不仅仅是一项服务，”曼雅说，“我们还是一种习惯，而习惯比罪行更难惩罚。”

谈了一周之后，领袖口述了一条简短的条款，当地人签了字。“你们自己，而不是无线电、不是网络直播、也不是那些小玩意，”她说，“你们不能把一个老式的承诺留给机器。”一位体贴的邻居拿来了羊毛毯，一位能说三种语言的流利者把条款向队伍朗读了一遍。

他们同意节省地花钱，并在报告里只留一句感叹：“终于！”这比一场争吵要好得多，他们的朋友——那位汽车旅馆老板娘——也这么说。一个夜里排队孩子、一位本地车主，以及一位在此生活了一辈子女士，站在柜台后面支持他们。家里的人总是有最后一句，这没什么不好。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
own əʊn POS: n	n. 自己的; a. 自己的, 嫡亲的, 同胞的; vt. 拥有, 支配, 自认, 承认, 顺从于; vi. 承认, 供认 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have ownership or possession of; s. belonging to or on behalf of a specified person (especially yourself);...
explain ik'spleɪn POS: v	v. 解释, 说明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make plain and comprehensible; v. define
obtain əb'teɪn POS: vt	vt. 获得, 达到; vi. 流行, 得到公认 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come into possession of
generally 'dʒenərəli POS: adv	adv. 通常, 逐渐地, 普遍地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. without distinction of one from others
chief tʃi:f POS: n	n. 领袖, 酋长, 长官, 主要部分; a. 主要的, 首位的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. most important element
wage weɪdʒ POS: n	n. 工资, 报应, 报偿; vt. 开展, 进行; vi. 进行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that remunerates
famous 'feɪməs POS: a	a. 出名的, 极好的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. widely known and esteemed
distinction dɪs'tɪŋkʃən POS: n	n. 区别 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a distinguishing quality; n. a distinguishing difference
specifically spi'sɪfɪkli POS: adv	adv. 特定地, 明确地, 按特性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in distinction from others
toss tɒs POS: n	n. 投掷, 抛, 摇摆, 震荡, 掷钱币决定; vt. 投掷, 猛抬, 摇荡, 使不安, 掷钱币决定; vi. 被到处扔, 摇摆, 颠簸, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abrupt movement; v. agitate
salary 'sæləri POS: n	n. 薪水; vt. 给...加薪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that remunerates
historic hɪ'storɪk POS: a	a. 历史上著名的, 有历史性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. belonging to the past; of what is important or famous in the past; s. important in history
altogether ˌɔ:lte'geðə POS: adv	adv. 完全地, 总而言之 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. with everything included or counted
ownership 'əʊnəʃɪp POS: n	n. 所有权, 物主身份; [经] 所有权, 所有制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relation of an owner to the thing possessed; possession with the right to transfer possession to other...
navy 'neɪvi POS: n	n. 海军, 海军人员, 海军军力, 烟蒂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an organization of military vessels belonging to a country and available for sea warfare
warrior 'wɔ:riə POS: n	n. 战士, 勇士, 武士, 鼓吹战争的人, 战斗, 尚武 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone engaged in or experienced in warfare
ballot 'bælət POS: n	n. 投票, 投票用纸, 抽签; vi. 投票, 抽签; vt. 投票选出, 拉选票 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document listing the alternatives that is used in voting; v. vote by ballot
inherit ɪn'herɪt POS: vt	vt. 继承, 遗传; vi. 接受遗产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. obtain from someone after their death; v. receive from a predecessor; v. receive by genetic transmission
punish 'pʌnɪʃ POS: vt	vt. 处罚, 惩罚, 严厉对待; vi. 惩罚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. impose a penalty on; inflict punishment on
solely 'səʊli POS: adv	adv. 仅仅, 单独地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. without any others being included or involved
pardon 'pɑ:dn POS: n	n. 原谅, 赦免; vt. 宽恕, 原谅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a warrant granting release from punishment for an offense; v. grant a pardon to
forthcoming 'fɔ:θ'kʌmɪŋ POS: a	a. 即将来临的; n. 来临 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. available when required or as promised
patent 'pætnɪt. POS: n	n. 专利权, 许可证, 执照, 专利品, 素质; a. 专利的, 特许的, 显著的, 新奇的; vt. 取得...的专利权, 请准专利 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document granting an inventor sole rights to an invention; n. an official document granting a right or pr...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
tyre 'taɪə POS: n	n. 轮胎; vt. 装轮胎于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a port in southern Lebanon on the Mediterranean Sea; formerly a major Phoenician seaport famous for silks; n...
allegedly ə'ledʒɪdli POS: adv	adv. 依其申述 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. according to what has been alleged
dictate 'dikteɪt POS: vi	vi. 听写, 口述, 口授; vt. 口述, 使听写, 命令; n. 命令, 指挥, 指令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an authoritative rule; n. a guiding principle; v. say out loud for the purpose of recording; v. rule as a dic...
diplomat 'dɪpləmət POS: n	n. 外交官, 有外交手腕的人; [法] 外交家, 外交官, 有权谋的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an official engaged in international negotiations; n. a person who deals tactfully with others
wireless 'waɪəlis POS: n	n. 无线电; a. 无线的, 无线电的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. transmission by radio waves; a. having no wires
disappointing ,dɪsə'pɔɪntɪŋ POS: a	a. 使失望的, 期待落空的, 令人沮丧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. not up to expectations
privatization phonetic unavailable POS: review required	[计] 私有化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n changing something from state to private ownership or control
dictator 'dɪkteɪtə POS: n	n. 命令者, 独裁者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a speaker who dictates to a secretary or a recording machine; n. a ruler who is unconstrained by law
wreck rek POS: n	n. 失事, 残骸, 破坏; vt. 使失事, 拆毁, 破坏; vi. (船)失事, 营救失事船只 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something or someone that has suffered ruin or dilapidation; n. a ship that has been destroyed at sea
yourselves jo:'selvz,jje-,je- POS: pron	pron. 你们自己 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pl. of Yourself
accordance ə'kɔ:dəns POS: n	n. 一致, 和谐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of granting rights
fluent 'flu:ənt POS: a	a. 流利的, 流畅的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. smooth and unconstrained in movement
privatize phonetic unavailable POS: vt	vt. vi. 私有化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. change from governmental to private control or ownership
exclamation ,ekskleɪ'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 惊呼, 激烈言词, 惊叹词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abrupt excited utterance; n. a loud complaint or protest or reproach
considerate kən'sɪdəɪt POS: a	a. 体贴的, 体谅的, 考虑周到的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. showing concern for the rights and feelings of others
woolen 'wulin POS: n	n. 毛制品; a. 羊毛的, 羊毛制的, 毛织的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or related to or made of wool
selfless 'selflis POS: a	a. 不顾自己的, 无私的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a showing unselfish concern for the welfare of others
sparingly phonetic unavailable POS: adv	adv. 节约地, 爱惜地, 吝惜地, 少量地, 贫乏地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r to a meager degree or in a meager manner
gadgetry 'gædʒɪtri POS: n	n. 小配件, 小玩意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. appliances collectively
webcast phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 网路广播; 网络广播; 网络直播 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.
old-fashioned 'əld'fæʃənd POS: a	a. 旧式的, 过时的, 保守的, 大人模样的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s out of fashion
well-known phonetic unavailable POS: a	a. 众所周知的, 有名的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. widely or fully known